

CDD:

Game Title: 音楽教室 (Ongaku Kyoshitsu) ["Music Class"]

Genre: Horror/Action

Platform: PC/Mobile/Console

Target Audience: Ages 17-23; Players interested in horror games, music/rhythm mechanics, and story-driven experiences

Document Version: v1.0

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Date: 31/1/26

1. High Concept Overview

In a seaside high school in **Sendai, Japan (1997)**, a senior investigates the disappearance of their classmates tied to a school rumor known as "**The Ghost of Music.**" The legend claims the Ghost punishes those who lose rhythm; but the truth is worse: **the Ghost actively sabotages the music itself**, turning it into a trap. The player must survive by **listening, adapting, and recovering from musical deception**, and finally find as many classmates as they can before the ghost takes over their future.

2. Game pillars/Design goals

- Music as the primary gameplay and narrative system
- Horror through loss of control and uncertainty
- No traditional combat; survival through rhythm
- Consequences that add to the new world instead of simple failure stages

3. Target Audience

- Fans of psychological and atmospheric horror
- Players who enjoy non-traditional mechanics
- Rhythm-game players seeking narrative depth
- Students/young adults interested in story-driven indie games
- Ages 17-23 (ideally - for relatability)

4. Genre + Platform

Genre: Horror/Action

Platforms: PC/Mobile/Console

Session Length: 1 hour

5. Core gameplay loop

- Player explores the school environment
- Finds distorted sheet music or audio clues
- Performs rhythm-based puzzles using instruments
- The Ghost interferes by swapping keys or altering tempo
- Player adapts mid-performance
- World and story change based on performance
- Player progresses deeper into the mystery

6. Mechanics overview

- Rhythm-Based Input System: Players perform melodies using timed inputs rather than combat controls
- Key-Swapping Mechanic: The Ghost can swap input keys during gameplay, causing the player to stumble if they rely only on memorization
- Corrupted Sheet Music: Notes may shift, disappear, or lie, forcing players to rely on sound instead of visuals
- Sound-Based Consequences: Enemies and environments react only to how the music is played
- No Game Over System: Mistakes permanently alter the environment and narrative instead of resetting progress
- Untuned Instruments:

7. Theme, Settings + Aesthetics

The game is set in a **1990s Japanese seaside high school**, featuring foggy empty hallways, abandoned classrooms. The visual style uses muted colors and subtle distortion, while audio design emphasizes warped brass sounds, silence, and off-key melodies.

8. Progression + Replayability

Progression is narrative-driven, with multiple outcomes depending on how the player performs music. Different levels of accuracy and recovery result in altered environments, missing characters, and multiple endings, encouraging replayability.

9. Emotional/Player exp goals

The game aims to create tension and discomfort by making players question their own timing and perception. Players should feel anxious during performances and satisfied when recovering from mistakes rather than playing perfectly.

10. Competitive Analysis

While inspired by rhythm and horror games, *The Ghost of Music* differentiates itself by intentionally disrupting player inputs and tying musical performance directly to narrative consequences rather than scoring.

11. Scope + Feasibility

Estimated Team Size: ~5 developers

Estimated Development Time: 4-6 months

Overall Complexity: Medium

The limited setting and mechanic-focused design make the project feasible for student or indie development.

12. Future expansion

- Additional instruments with unique interference patterns
- New school myths tied to different musical styles
- Adjustable Ghost difficulty and behavior
- Expanded story routes and endings